9.2.6. Magnesium

Magnesium is the second most abundant intracellular cation after potassium. Adult human body contains about 25g of magnesium. Bones contain nearly 70% of the body magnesium contributing as magnesium phosphate, which is about 1.5% of bone matter.

Functions

1. Magnesium, along with sodium, potassium and calcium controls the neuro muscular irritability.
2. Magnesium is involved in the synthesis of proteins and nucleic acids.
3. Magnesium is essential for the activity of peptidases and ribonucleases.
4. It is an activator of many glycolytic enzymes, particularly in muscle.

   Example : pyruvate kinase and enolase.
5. It plays an important role in oxidative phosphorylation.

Sources



Figure 9.8 Sources of Magnesium

Unit 9.indd 237 21-05-2018 15:12:12